

⚠ Trading gold, forex and CFDs on margin carries a high level of risk and you could lose more than your initial deposit. 70–80% of retail investor accounts lose money when trading CFDs. Past performance is not indicative of future results. All content is for education only and is not financial advice.

PREMIUM SOP · EDITION 01

DISCIPLINE ***SOP***

Ten faults that take money off you, ten demo drills that remove them, and the standard you clear before a single live order goes in.

10

Faults, each with its drill

40

Demo sample before live trades, journalled

90%

Rule adherence to clear

Psychology and demo trading · Reviewed by Sam · Education only

REVIEWED BY
Sam

CONTENTS

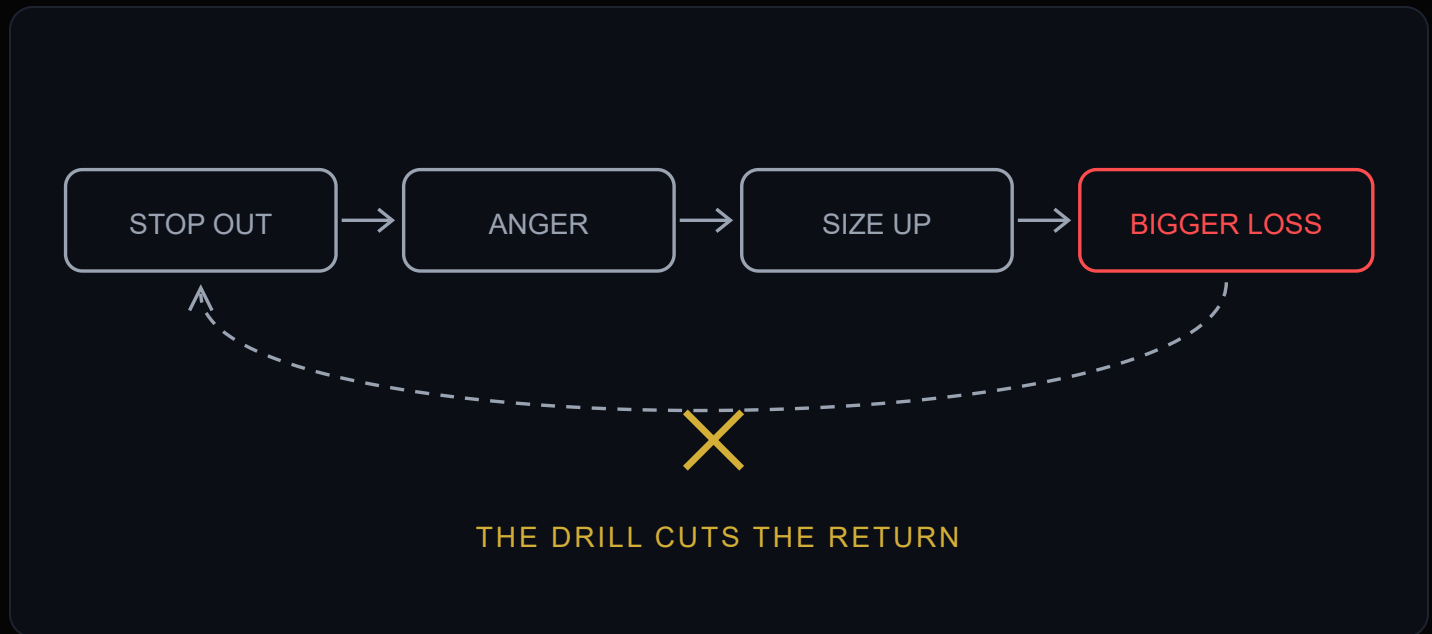
I	Part I — Fault and drill	P3
01	Revenge trading after a loss	P3
02	Fear of pulling the trigger	P3
03	Fear of missing out	P4
04	Moving the stop loss	P4
05	Cutting winners early	P5
06	Overconfidence after a win streak	P5
07	Boredom trading	P6
08	Tilt and screen fatigue	P6
09	Refusing to accept a -1R	P7
10	Position size creep	P7
II	Part II — The graduation standard	P8
A	Appendix A — Journal template	P9
B	Appendix B — 30-day demo programme	P10
C	Appendix C — Tilt checklist	P11

FAULT AND DRILL

Nobody loses an account to a bad setup. Accounts go to the same ten decisions, made under pressure, over and over. Each mission below names one fault, gives you the tell so you can catch it live, and hands you a demo drill with a pass condition you can count. A drill you cannot count is a wish.

Demo exists for exactly this. It is not for finding out whether your strategy works — it is for finding out whether you do.

FIGURE 1



Schematic. The loop is what costs money, not the first stop. Every drill in Part I exists to cut the dashed line.

MISSION 01

Revenge trading after a loss

Objective — make the next trade after a stop loss identical in size and quality to the one before it.

THE TELL

You are back on the chart inside five minutes, looking for a reason rather than a setup. The word "back" is in your head — get it back, win it back.

THE DRILL

A 60 minute stand-down after every stop loss. Platform closed, journal row written first. The next entry must be a full setup, at the same lot, or there is no next entry today.

Pass condition. 20 demo trades with zero entries inside 60 minutes of a stop, and no lot size above your standard.

Fear of pulling the trigger

Objective — remove the moment of decision from the moment of entry.

THE TELL

The setup was there, you watched it, you did not click. Then you widen your rules to justify entering the next one late.

THE DRILL

Pending orders only, for 20 trades. Set the entry, the stop loss and the take profit while price is still away from the level, then leave the platform. You are not allowed to fill manually.

Pass condition. 20 consecutive trades entered by pending order, and every valid setup in your journal either ordered or written off with a stated reason.

MISSION 03

Fear of missing out

Objective — make a missed move cost you nothing.

THE TELL

You enter after the move has already left the level, with the stop loss now three times its normal distance, because being in feels better than being out.

THE DRILL

Keep a missed-trade log. Every move you did not take gets a row: what it was, why you skipped it, and what it would have paid in R. Read it at the end of the week.

Pass condition. Four weeks of missed-trade logs, and zero entries taken more than 15 pips from your planned entry.

MISSION 04

Moving the stop loss

Objective — make the stop loss a fact, not an opinion you revisit.

THE TELL

Price approaches your stop and you find a reason the level "needs more room". A $-1R$ becomes $-2.5R$, and you call it patience.

THE DRILL

Stop loss set at entry, then the platform closes. The only permitted change is to breakeven after TP1 is paid. Widening is logged as a rule break even when the trade recovers.

Pass condition. 40 demo trades with no stop loss widened. A recovered trade where you widened still counts as a fail.

MISSION 05

Cutting winners early

Objective — let the plan close the trade instead of your nerves.

THE TELL

You close at $+0.4R$ because it "might come back", then watch TP2 pay. Your win rate looks fine and your R is flat.

THE DRILL

Fixed partial: half at TP1, stop loss to breakeven, the remainder runs to target or gets stopped at entry. No manual closes. If you want out early, log it as a rule break.

Pass condition. 20 winners closed by order, not by hand, and average win at or above $1.6R$.

MISSION 06

Overconfidence after a win streak

Objective — keep the fourth trade the same size as the first.

THE TELL

Three wins in, and the next setup gets double size because you are "reading it well". The market did not agree to that.

THE DRILL

One lot size for the whole 40-trade sample. Size only changes between samples, never inside one, and never on a feeling.

Pass condition. Every trade in the sample at the same risk. One lot size, 40 rows, no exceptions.

Boredom trading

Objective — make screen time a decision, not a default.

THE TELL

Nothing is set up, so you drop to M1 and find something. These trades are never in your plan and always in your history.

THE DRILL

A stated session window, in MYT, written before the week starts. Outside it the platform is closed. No setup in the window means a flat day, which you log as a flat day.

Pass condition. Four weeks with every entry inside the stated window, and at least five logged flat days.

Tilt and screen fatigue

Objective — stop the day before the day stops you.

THE TELL

Six hours in, you are clicking faster and reading less. You cannot remember why you are in the current trade.

THE DRILL

Two stops in a day and you are done — platform closed, no review until tomorrow. Also done after three hours of screen time, win or lose.

Pass condition. Every two-stop day in the sample ends at the second stop. Zero third trades.

FIGURE 2



Schematic. The second stop ends the day whether or not the setup after it looks good. That is the whole rule.

MISSION 09

Refusing to accept a -1R

Objective — treat a stop loss as the price of the trade, not as a verdict on you.

THE TELL

You hide the loss: no journal row, no screenshot, and a story about the spread. What is not written down gets repeated.

THE DRILL

Publish every loss to yourself before the next trade. Row written, reason stated in one sentence, rule break marked or not marked. A clean -1R is a good trade and gets recorded as one.

Pass condition. Every loss in the sample journalled, with at least five marked "clean loss, no rule broken".

MISSION 10

Position size creep

Objective — compute size from the stop distance, never from how sure you feel.

THE TELL

Your lot size drifts up across the month with no decision behind it. Ask when it changed and you cannot say.

THE DRILL

Size is calculated before you look at the entry price: risk 1% of the account, divided by the stop distance in pips. Write the number in the journal before the order is placed.

Pass condition. 40 rows where risk sits at 1% within a tenth of a percent, computed before entry.

THE GRADUATION STANDARD

Demo ends on a number, not on a feeling. Three gates, in order. Fail one and the sample restarts — not the drills, the sample.

GATE 1 — ADHERENCE, NOT PROFIT

At least 90% of the 40 trades carry zero rule breaks. Profit is not consulted at this gate. A profitable sample with 70% adherence is a lucky sample and it does not pass.

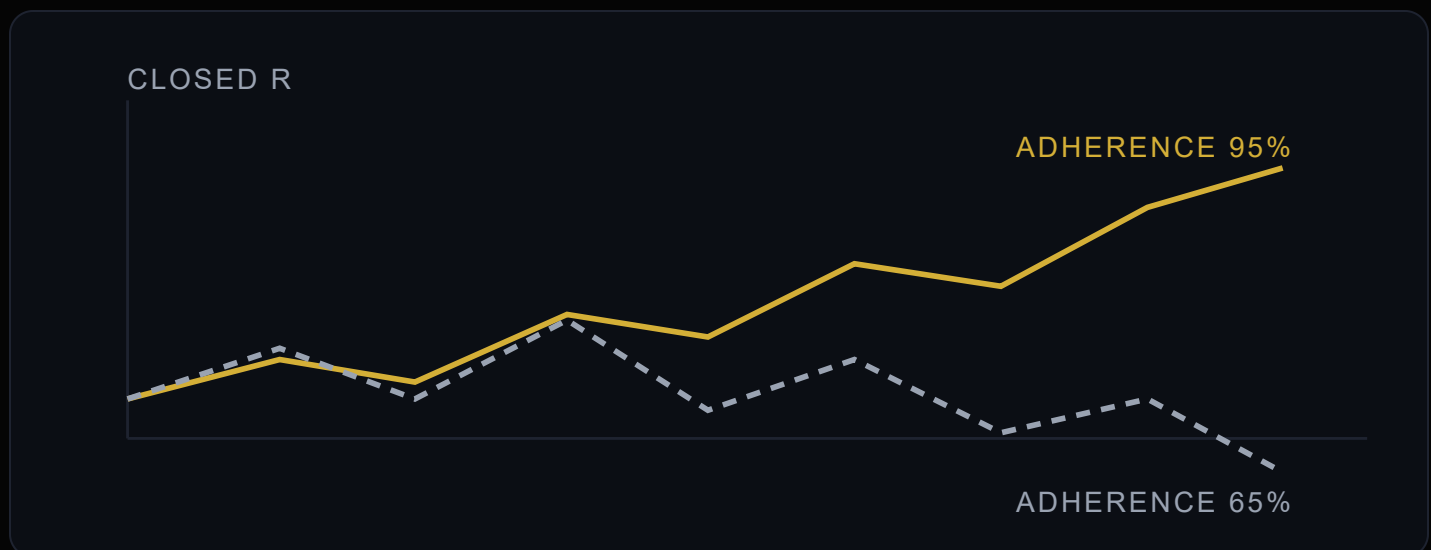
GATE 2 — POSITIVE R ACROSS THE SAMPLE

Net R above zero over the full 40 trades. Not per week, not per day, not on your best ten. The whole sample, losses included.

GATE 3 — A CLEAN FINAL 20

The last 20 consecutive trades carry no rule breaks at all. Not 90% — zero. Break one on trade 39 and the count restarts at one.

FIGURE 3



Schematic. Same setups, same win rate, different obedience. Adherence is the variable you control, so it is the one we score.

A sample that did not pass

Illustrative numbers, scored the way yours should be.

40

Trades in sample

+6.4R

Net closed

82%Rule adherence
7 breaks**11**Clean run at the end
needs 20

Gate 2 passed and the other two failed, so the sample failed. Seven breaks: four stops widened, two entries inside the 60 minute stand-down, one double lot after a win streak. The profit came from six good setups and hid all of it. Restart the sample, keep the drills.

What five stops in a row actually costs

AT 1% RISK

Five stops is **-5R**, about 5% of the account. Two clean setups at 2.5R each put it back.

AT 3% RISK

The same five stops is **-15%**. Now you need 18% to get level, and the pressure to force a trade is exactly the pressure that lost it.

SIZING UP MID-STREAK

1%, 1%, 2%, 3%, 5% is **-12%** from the same five losing trades. The streak did not change; your obedience did.

Five stops in a row is a normal run at any honest win rate. Plan for it at 1% and it is a bad fortnight. Plan for it at 3% and it is the account.

JOURNAL TEMPLATE

One row per trade, written before the platform closes. Twelve fields, no essays.

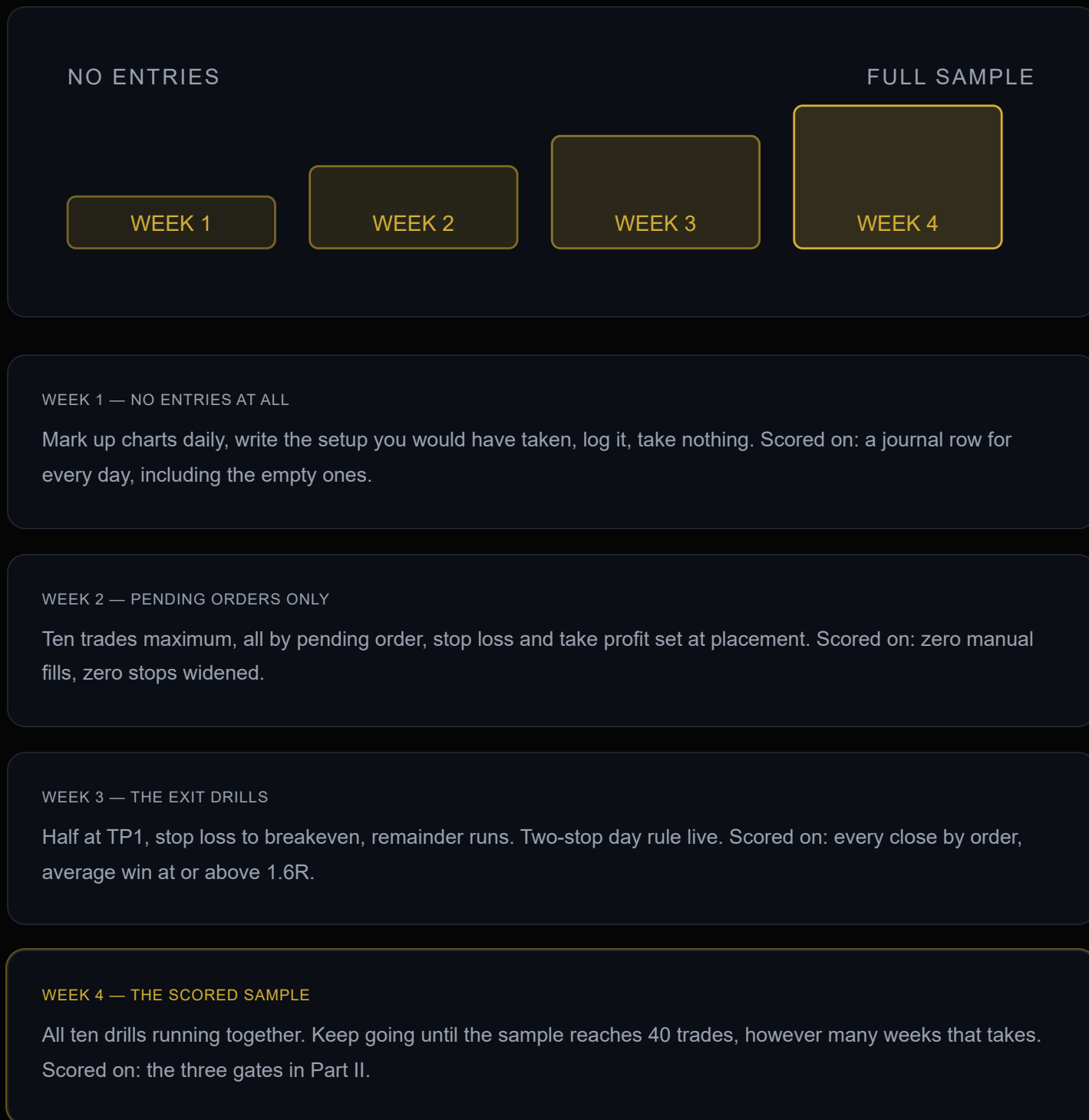
01	Date and session	MYT
02	Setup name	PLAN REF
03	Risk computed before entry	% OF ACCOUNT
04	Stop distance	PIPS
05	Lot size	LOTS
06	Entry type	PENDING / MARKET
07	Result	R CLOSED
08	How it closed	ORDER / BY HAND
09	Rule break	WHICH ONE, OR NONE
10	Minutes since the last stop loss	MIN
11	Screen time before entry	HOURS
12	One sentence: what you would repeat	TEXT

Fields 09, 10 and 11 are the ones that score you. Most traders keep the first eight and wonder why the journal never changes anything.

30-DAY DEMO PROGRAMME

Four weeks, one focus each, one thing you are scored on. Demo size matches the live account you intend to open — not a fantasy balance.

FIGURE 4



Thirty days is the floor, not the target. If week 4 needs six weeks to reach 40 trades, it takes six weeks. Going live early is the most expensive way to save time.

TILT CHECKLIST

One yes is enough. Close the platform, write the row, come back tomorrow.

- Two stop losses already today.
- You are looking for a trade rather than waiting for one.
- You have moved to a lower timeframe than your plan names.
- You thought about the money in this trade instead of the R.
- You have checked the position more than twice in ten minutes.
- Your hand is on the stop loss and price has not reached your level.
- Three hours or more of screen time.
- You cannot say in one sentence why you are in the trade.
- You are trading a size you did not compute.
- You are angry at the market, the broker, or the news.

Print it and keep it beside the screen. The checklist only works if you read it at the moment you least want to.

RISK WARNING

Trading gold, forex and CFDs on margin carries a high level of risk and you could lose more than your initial deposit. 70–80% of retail investor accounts lose money when trading CFDs. Past performance is not indicative of future results. All content is for education only and is not financial advice.

EDUCATION ONLY

All signals, analysis and content provided by Sam are for educational purposes only and do not constitute financial, investment or trading advice. We are not a licensed financial adviser. You are solely responsible for your trading decisions.

IB DISCLOSURE

SAMBANGGOLD is an Introducing Broker partner of HFM and earns commission on referred accounts.